



HEMANT CHAWLA



VIKRAM SHARMA

1. AROON PURIE WITH MUSHARRAF; 2. ADI GODREJ, KASPAROV, IRSHAD MANJI, SHAHID MALIK, REKHA PURIE, MUSHARRAF'S WIFE SEMBA, PARMESHWAR GODREJ, NYNA MITTAL; 3. THE DALAI LAMA WITH BIRLA; 4. ROHINI NILEKANI, FAROOQ, MUSHARRAF AND PURIE; 5. KHAN AND JOHAR; 6. OMAR WITH WIFE PAYAL; 7. PRIYANKA AND BINDRA



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RAVI S SAHNI



REUBEN SINGH

delegates asked General V.P. Malik what he would feel when he shook hands with his former enemy—a photo-op that no one missed—while there was an array of guests waiting to congratulate Maulana Mahmood Madani for telling the General to keep off Indian Muslim affairs. For Malik, the handshake was historic but Musharraf “was a man you couldn’t trust”.

Earlier on Day 2, two world beaters Priyanka Chopra and Abhinav Bindra exchanged notes. The sharpshooter told her he’d watched her movie, *Fashion*. The former Miss World replied, “I watched you winning the Gold as well.” Bindra carried his speaker-card in his hand as it said ‘Olympic Gold Medallist’, being somewhat embarrassed to have it hanging around his neck. The real McCoy, his Beijing medal, he said, is kept in his mother’s closet.

Farhan Akhtar was deep in discussion with Hero Honda’s Pawan Munjal as Shahjahanpur MP

Jitin Prasada talked about his hectic election schedule. Chopra reminded him she was from Uttar Pradesh, and he promptly invited her to canvass for him. The actor had just flown in from Florence, where she had gone at the invitation of the Ferragamos who want to showcase her foot impression in their museum. Akhtar was tired, having just ended two days of partying for friends Amrita Arora and Shakeel Ladak’s wedding.

Everyone was busy preparing for their speeches, whether it was Garry Kasparov trying to get the pronunciation of *ahimsa*, *satyagraha* and Piyush (Bobby Jindal’s real name) right; Shah Rukh, who lent his Ferrari pen drive to take a printout of his speech, most of it in his trademark all capitals; or Chopra, who borrowed a green marker from the hotel staff to highlight her written speech and then didn’t refer to it at all in her flawless rendition. Admirers were